Teacher Guide & Answers

Passage Reading Level: Lexile 1200

1. What does genetic information dictate, or control?

- **A** **what characteristics an organism will have**
- **B** where an organism will live and die
- **C** which predators will eat the organism
- **D** who the organism's parents were

2. The passage describes the sequence of a butterfly's life. Which of the following shows the life cycle of a butterfly in the correct order?

- **A** egg, pupa, adult, caterpillar
- **B** pupa, egg, caterpillar, adult
- **C** **egg, caterpillar, pupa, adult**
- **D** egg, pupa, caterpillar, adult

3. Monarch butterflies are protected by their bright coloration. What evidence from the passage supports this conclusion?

- **A** Their bright coloration makes monarch butterflies easily noticeable to predators.
- **B** **The monarch's color warns predators that they are poisonous, so they don't get eaten.**
- **C** Unlike other butterflies, monarchs do not blend into their surroundings to protect themselves.
- **D** If a predator eats a monarch, it can taste the poison and will spit the butterfly out.

4. Butterfly A is blue with black markings. Butterfly B is green with brown spots. What conclusion can you make about these two butterflies?

- **A** Both butterflies protect themselves by blending into their surroundings.
- **B** The two butterflies have different life cycles.
- **C** Both butterflies have the same genetic information.
- **D** **The two butterflies have different genetic information.**

5. What is this passage mostly about?

- **A** **monarch butterflies**
- **B** viceroy butterflies
- **C** milkweed toxins
- **D** caterpillars and pupae

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6. Read the following sentences: "Inside the chrysalis, the pupa grows the legs, wings, and other parts of an adult butterfly. Once the butterfly is fully **developed**, the chrysalis splits apart, and the butterfly emerges."

What does the word "**developed**" mean?

A young and small
B **changed and grown**
C safe and protected
D soft and vulnerable

7. Choose the answer that best completes the sentence below.

Monarch butterflies are brightly colored; _____, they are highly visible to predators.

A however
B for example
C **as a result**
D initially

8. Why are monarch butterflies poisonous?

Suggested answer: Monarch butterflies are poisonous because as caterpillars they eat a plant called milkweed, which is poisonous to most vertebrates (but not to monarchs).

9. How do predators know that monarch butterflies are poisonous?

Suggested answer: Predators know that monarch butterflies are poisonous because of their bright coloration, which acts as a warning that they are poisonous.

10. How does the monarch's coloration help both the butterfly and its predators?

Suggested answer: The monarch's coloration helps the butterfly, because it protects the butterfly from predators. The butterfly's coloration helps predators, because it warns them that the butterfly is poisonous to eat.

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